

MARKETING PORTFOLIO

Rebuilding KA-CHING

Sachin Nawadia

Commerce Society of Ram Lal Anand College, University of Delhi

I build marketing strategies by finding the gap between what a brand is doing and what its audience is telling it to do — then closing it with sharp creative and consistent execution.

Head of Marketing & Creative, KA-CHING

Tenure: 2024–25

Four case studies: rebranding a department-limited society, launching a 500+ registration flagship simulation, scaling to a 600+ participant annual fest, and building an educational content engine across Instagram and LinkedIn.

CASE STUDY 1 — BRAND & TEAM
TURNAROUND

Rebuilding the Brand

KA-CHING was limited to the commerce department, led by unstable leadership, and posting low-engagement content. I rebuilt the brand identity and the team from the ground up.

Logo, Team & Brand Foundation

THE PROBLEM

Before I became Head of Marketing & Creative, I had spent my first year on KA-CHING's graphics team and watched several structural problems compound. The society's reach was limited almost entirely to the commerce department, with little visibility elsewhere in college. Leadership was unstable — my own head at the time had little direction, then left the society mid-tenure, and the person who replaced her had no real accountability or grip on the graphics department. The output reflected this: minimal visual design, basic reels, low engagement, and an Instagram following stuck around 500–600. Event participation was correspondingly weak.

MY THINKING

A society can't fix low engagement or low reach with better content alone if the underlying brand identity and team structure are themselves broken. I treated this as two parallel fixes rather than a content problem:

- Fix the identity first: the existing logo didn't clearly communicate what KA-CHING stood for, so I redesigned it to better convey the society's message before investing in any campaign-level creative built on top of it.
- Fix the team structure: having seen first-hand what happens when a department has unclear leadership and no accountability, I built and led a 15+ member Marketing & Creative team with clearer ownership from the start, rather than repeating the structure that had failed the year before.

This sequencing mattered because every campaign that followed — K-Street, Comverse, the content series — depended on having both a coherent visual identity and a team that could actually execute consistently, neither of which existed when I took over.

THE WORK

- Redesigned KA-CHING's logo to better convey the society's identity and purpose.
- Built and led a 15+ member Marketing & Creative team for the 2024–25 tenure.
- Established the visual and structural foundation that every subsequent campaign (K-Street, Comverse, content series) was built on.

THE RESULT

15+	1
Marketing & Creative team built	Society-wide rebrand (new logo)

This groundwork directly enabled everything that followed: K-Street's 500+ registrations, Comverse's 600+ participants, and the Instagram and LinkedIn growth covered in the later case studies. None of that would have been executable with the team structure and brand identity that existed before.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

Having seen a leadership transition go badly (a head leaving mid-tenure with no handover), I'd build a basic documentation or handover process for the Marketing & Creative team early on — a simple log of brand guidelines, ongoing campaign status, and key contacts — so the department's continuity wouldn't depend entirely on one person staying through the full tenure.

CASE STUDY 2 — FLAGSHIP
CAMPAIGN

K-Street

A stock market simulation event marketed for six weeks straight — nostalgia-driven reels, cross-college collabs, and multiple sponsors — landed 500+ registrations and 90+ positive reviews.

Stock Market Simulation Event

THE PROBLEM

K-Street was KA-CHING's first event of the 2024–25 tenure, and it needed to do more than just run smoothly — it had to prove that the rebrand and new team could actually deliver, after a year of low participation and a weak digital presence. A stock market simulation is also a fairly involved concept to explain to a general college audience, which made the marketing job harder than a simple one-line event.

MY THINKING

I treated K-Street as a long-runway campaign rather than a short promotional burst — marketing started a full six weeks before the event. A few deliberate choices shaped the approach:

- Theme-matched visual language: all posters, banners, and Instagram posts used a bull-and-bear stock market motif, so the creative itself taught people what the event was about before they read a single caption.
- Nostalgia-driven reels for reach: rather than generic event-announcement reels, we used old, well-known Indian ads (Center Fruit, Imperial Blue) and their songs, combined with trending memes, to ride existing audio/format popularity instead of competing against it. This pushed average reel views past 30,000.
- Going beyond our own audience: we promoted in other colleges directly and partnered with their societies for joint reach, instead of relying solely on our own follower base.
- Sponsorship as both funding and credibility: bringing on sponsors like Lazer Crazer, Skyjumpers, and Unstop signaled to participants that this was a serious, well-backed event, not just an internal college activity.
- On-ground conversion: registration desks and posters on physical noticeboards in our own college caught the segment of students who don't convert from social media alone.

THE WORK

- 6-week pre-event marketing campaign across Instagram, LinkedIn, and WhatsApp.
- Bull/bear stock-market-themed posters, banners, and Instagram creative.
- Meme and nostalgic-ad-format reels (Center Fruit, Imperial Blue) for organic reach.
- Cross-college promotion and society collaborations for expanded participation.
- Secured sponsorships: Lazer Crazer, Skyjumpers, Unstop, and others.
- On-ground registration desks and poster placements within Ram Lal Anand College.

THE RESULT

500+ Registrations	90+ Positive reviews	30K+ Average reel views
------------------------------	--------------------------------	-----------------------------------

K-Street became a strong proof point for the rebuilt team and brand: over 500 registrations, more than 90 positive reviews, and reels that consistently crossed 30,000 views — a sharp jump from the 500–600 follower, low-engagement baseline the society had before this tenure.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

I didn't formally track which channel — the meme reels, cross-college collabs, sponsor visibility, or on-ground desks — actually drove the most registrations. With a six-week campaign and this many simultaneous channels, even simple registration-source tracking (a dropdown on the form, or unique links per channel) would have shown which investment to scale first for K-Street's next edition or for Comverse.

CASE STUDY 3 — ANNUAL
FLAGSHIP FEST

Comverse

KA-CHING's annual fest scaled the K-Street playbook across four sub-events with a space theme, drawing 600+ participants and launching a dedicated WhatsApp channel for retention.

Multi-Event Annual Fest

THE PROBLEM

After K-Street's success, the next test was whether that result was repeatable at a larger, more complex scale. Comverse was KA-CHING's annual flagship fest, with four distinct sub-events — a speaker session, a case competition, a treasure hunt, and an ad-mad competition — running under one umbrella. That meant marketing not just one event concept, but four different formats simultaneously, while keeping a single coherent fest identity.

MY THINKING

Rather than inventing a new playbook, I applied what had already worked for K-Street — a strong unifying visual theme, an extended promotion runway, and cross-college plus on-ground push — and adapted it for a multi-event structure. Comverse used a space theme across all its creative, which gave four otherwise-unrelated sub-events (a talk, a competition, a hunt, an ad contest) one consistent visual identity to be promoted under, rather than four disconnected campaigns competing for attention.

I also introduced a dedicated WhatsApp channel, Ledger Folio, specifically for Comverse and ongoing society updates. The reasoning: Instagram and LinkedIn are good for discovery, but a WhatsApp channel gave us a direct, low-noise line to people who had already engaged once — useful for retention and repeat participation across the fest's four sub-events, not just a single one-off event.

THE WORK

- Led creative direction across four sub-events (speaker session, case competition, treasure hunt, ad-mad competition) under one space-themed visual identity.
- Applied the K-Street promotion playbook — long runway, cross-college reach, on-ground registration push — at fest scale.
- Launched Ledger Folio, a dedicated WhatsApp channel for direct updates and retention.

THE RESULT

600+

Total participation

4

Sub-events under one fest

Comverse drew more than 600 participants across its four sub-events with consistently positive reviews — confirming that the K-Street approach wasn't a one-off result but a repeatable system, even when applied to a more complex, multi-event format.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

With four sub-events running under one fest, I'd build a shared content calendar with explicit per-event posting slots from the start. In practice, some sub-events likely got more creative attention than others simply based on timeline pressure rather than a deliberate decision — a calendar would have made that an intentional choice instead of an accident of scheduling.

CASE STUDY 4 — CONTENT &
DIGITAL STRATEGY

Building an Educational Content Engine

Beyond event promotion, I built always-on content formats — brand case studies, duopoly comparisons, and a weekly news series — that grew Instagram from 600 to 1,300 and LinkedIn from 400 to 810.

From Sparse Posting to a Content System

THE PROBLEM

Before this tenure, KA-CHING's Instagram had minimal visual design, basic reels, and low engagement, sitting around 500–600 followers with little LinkedIn presence at all. Even with successful flagship events like K-Street and Comverse driving spikes in attention, the society had no always-on content strategy to keep people engaged between events — every gain risked decaying back to baseline once an event ended.

MY THINKING

Rather than only posting event promotion, I built recurring educational content formats that gave people a reason to follow KA-CHING even when there wasn't an event happening — reframing the page from “a college society that posts when it has something on” to a page people followed for the content itself:

- Documentary-style case studies on well-known brands (Apple, Uber, MDH), covering their failures and successes, to give followers genuinely useful business insight rather than generic motivational content.
- A duopoly series comparing two dominant competitors in an industry — Coca-Cola vs. Pepsi, Marvel vs. DC, PlayStation vs. Xbox — a format chosen because head-to-head comparisons are inherently shareable and easy to have an opinion on, which helps organic reach.
- ComSoc Weekly, a recurring Sunday series covering the week's top business and commerce news, which gave the page a reliable, dependable content rhythm instead of sporadic posting.

Across all three formats, the focus was consistently on educational, well-designed content rather than just promotional posts — positioning KA-CHING as a source of commerce-relevant insight, not just an events page.

THE WORK

- Launched a documentary-style brand case study series (Apple, Uber, MDH, and others).
- Launched a duopoly comparison series (Coca-Cola vs. Pepsi, Marvel vs. DC, PlayStation vs. Xbox).
- Launched ComSoc Weekly, a recurring Sunday business news recap series.
- Overhauled overall graphic design quality across Instagram and LinkedIn.
- Produced the KA-CHING annual magazine, documenting the year's work and student achievements.

THE RESULT

600 → 1,300

Instagram followers

400 → 810

LinkedIn followers

1

Annual magazine produced

Instagram followers roughly doubled and LinkedIn followers grew similarly over the year, alongside a visible jump in content quality and engagement consistency. The recurring formats meant KA-CHING's digital presence no longer depended entirely on event-driven spikes — it had a content identity of its own, capped off by an annual magazine that documented the full year's work and the society's student achievements.

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

I didn't formally A/B test which of the three series (case studies, duopoly, weekly news) drove the most follower growth versus just views or saves. With three concurrent recurring formats, knowing which one converted best would have let us either double down on the strongest format or fix the weaker ones earlier in the year rather than running all three at equal effort throughout.

Skills Developed Through This Role

Leading KA-CHING's marketing and creative function across a brand rebuild, two flagship campaigns, and a full content system built a focused set of skills:

- Leadership — built and led a 15+ member Marketing & Creative team after observing first-hand what unstable leadership does to a department.
- Brand identity & design — redesigned the society's logo and oversaw all visual identity across events and content.
- Campaign strategy — ran multi-week, multi-channel campaigns (K-Street, Comverse) combining organic content, collaborations, and sponsorships.
- Sponsorship & partnerships — secured and managed sponsor relationships (Lazer Crazer, Skyjumpers, Unstop) and cross-college society collaborations.
- Content strategy — designed and sustained three concurrent recurring educational content series across Instagram and LinkedIn.
- Event marketing — planned and executed long-runway (6-week) promotional campaigns for events with 500–600+ participants.
- Brand storytelling — produced an annual magazine documenting a full year of society work and achievements.